

Ministry of the Holy Spirit in You

In 1 Corinthians 2, beginning at verse 12, Paul is saying exactly the same thing he says in Romans 8. The difference is that in Romans he is speaking to a Jewish community, especially in chapter 7, where he differentiates between the covenant of law and the covenant that resulted in sonship.

In Romans 7 he says:

"I speak to them that know the law."

Then he shows how a spiritually dead man could not keep the law. The dilemma is described this way:

"The good that I would, I do not:
but the evil which I would not, that I do."

He is trying with his mind to keep the law: "Do not covet. Do not bear false witness." So he says that if he does what he does not want to do, it is no longer he that does it, but sin, that nature dwelling in him.

Then he comes to adoption:

"For ye have not received the spirit of bondage again to fear."

The more the spiritually dead Jew tried to serve God under law, the more bondage and fear it generated. That is why the Levitical priesthood shed so much blood. God operated with them in shadow until the fullness of time came.

Then God sent forth His Son, made of a woman, made under the law. Because He was born under the law, He was obligated to keep it. He was the first man in four thousand years who could keep it, because He was born spiritually alive with a human spirit that had God's nature in it, just like you do now.

He kept the law and fulfilled it. That released Him to step into the shoes of every Jew who could not keep it. He was made a curse in their place to release them from the law, so that they also might receive the adoption of sons.

In 1 Corinthians, Paul is dealing with Gentiles. They had been spiritually dead, and now they were spiritually alive. He wanted them to understand what happened to them.

First Corinthians 2:12 says:

"Now we have received,
not the spirit of the world,
but the spirit which is of God;
that we might know the things
that are freely given to us of God."

The spirit of the world is the spirit received from Adam when we were born of flesh. The spirit which is of God is the born-again human spirit that came from God. Now that we have His nature, we are qualified to know spiritual things. We can be taught by God.

Verse 13 says:

"Which things also we speak,
not in the words which man's wisdom teacheth,
but which the Holy Ghost teacheth;
comparing spiritual things with spiritual."

These are the things God has taught us. The Holy Spirit teaches our new nature in a language God teaches. Praying in tongues is included here. We understand mysteries and spiritual things because our spirit has been taught by the Holy Spirit.

Paul continues:

"But the natural man receiveth not the things of the Spirit of God:
for they are foolishness unto him:
neither can he know them,
because they are spiritually discerned."

The natural man, the unregenerated man, cannot receive these things and cannot even know them. They are spiritually discerned.

Then Paul says:

"But he that is spiritual judgeth all things,
yet he himself is judged of no man."

Why? Because his source is not from this planet. The Holy Spirit teaches spiritual things to the born-again spirit. Paul is saying, "He taught us, and now we are teaching you."

Then he says:

"For who hath known the mind of the Lord,
that he may instruct him?
But we have the mind of Christ."

You received the mind of Christ when you were baptized in the Holy Spirit. The Father, Son, and Holy Spirit do not search one another as though one lacks knowledge. God does not search Himself. They operate as one God in three Persons.

When Scripture speaks of searching the deep things of God, it is not saying God is searching Himself. It means your born-again spirit now has the capacity to search the things of God, even the deep things.

If you are not baptized in the Holy Spirit, you have received His nature, but you still need to be taught. You can take on the mind of Christ by meditating on the Word of God. But when you are baptized in the Holy Spirit, He steps into you with the mind of Christ, and His intention is to teach you what is in that mind.

He brought a prayer language with Him, and contained within that prayer language is the mind of Christ. The more you let Him pray that mind, the more He can reveal to you what is in that mind.

The mind of Christ includes the entire Word of God as written to mankind corporately, but it also specializes. The Holy Spirit came as an Individual to represent you. His intention is to fulfill the calling of Christ in you to the rest of the Body and to the world.

If you want to give Him a head start, let Him pray for you. The more you let Him pray for you, the better off you will be. Some people think you get strange from praying too much in tongues because you stop acting carnal like they do. When you bring conviction on people, they want to mark you quickly.

Romans 8 takes from verse 15 to verse 27 to say what 1 Corinthians 2 says from verses 12 to 16. Romans gives more detail because Paul is addressing the Jewish background of law and adoption. Corinthians says it briefly to people coming out of paganism.

Romans 8:15 says:

"For ye have not received the spirit of bondage again to fear;
but ye have received the Spirit of adoption,
whereby we cry, Abba, Father."

First Corinthians says:

"We have received, not the spirit of the world,
but the spirit which is of God."

To the Jew, Paul says, "You did not receive the spirit of bondage again to fear." To the Gentile, he says, "You did not receive the spirit of the world." In both places, the answer is the same: you received a born-again human spirit from God.

Your spirit went from death to life. You received a new Father. You were literally adopted out of the old nature and sin into God's family. Out of that new nature, you can cry, "Abba, Father."

Then Romans 8:16 introduces the Holy Spirit distinctly:

"The Spirit itself beareth witness with our spirit,
that we are the children of God."

His Spirit bears witness with mine that I am His son.

The next mention of the Holy Spirit is Romans 8:26:

"Likewise the Spirit also helpeth our infirmities."

He says "also" because something else is already helping: the new nature. When I was born again and adopted into God's family, sin lost its dominion over me. The law of the spirit of life, my human spirit with God's life in it, set me free from the law of sin and death.

Now God has sent another Person. The Holy Spirit is not me, and I am not Him. I am a human being, an individual, and I always will be. So are you. My human spirit is one person; the Holy Spirit is another.

When God told Adam to replenish the earth, He was not primarily speaking to Adam's body. He was speaking to the human spirit, to spiritual beings coming into existence. That is what puts you in God's class. Fatherhood and motherhood matter because the eternal life you father or mother will go to heaven or hell, depending on what is done with it.

God gets great fellowship from us when we do not have to love Him, yet by an act of our own will we turn to Him and love Him. He loves that. You became a new person, adopted into His family. The Holy Spirit is not you; He is the third Person of the Godhead. And God loves you.

The new nature helped me first. Even if the Holy Spirit never came, I might flounder around and not know much about God's will, but I would still be free from sin. The new nature is what the Holy Spirit enforces.

Then the Holy Spirit also helps my infirmities. I do not know how to pray as I ought, so He steps in with a supernatural language of groanings that cannot be uttered in natural articulation. Its origin is not of this world.

Like any teacher-student relationship, He is one Person and you are another. The whole world of heaven lives in Him. The whole Kingdom is in Him. All that God is, is in Him. There are things He has that you need to know. Through all the ages, you may never exhaust what He knows, but He

has come to teach you what you need to know.

He has come to guide you into all truth and to be the power of the resurrection of Christ. Jesus said:

"Ye shall receive power,
after that the Holy Ghost is come upon you."

He is not only your Teacher; He is also there to back up what He teaches. If He teaches that you have power over the enemy, He backs it up. If He teaches that you have power over sickness and disease, He backs it up.

If baptism in the Holy Spirit automatically made everyone know everything He knows, every Spirit-filled person would teach the same thing. We do not need to look far to see that is not true. There is a teaching process. You can loose the Teacher inside you every day of your life.

One of the primary tools of that teaching process goes beyond your ignorance: praying in tongues. You might not even own a Bible. You might be born again in Russia or Mongolia and not be able to read. It does not matter. When the mind of Christ is deposited in you, that is the mind the Bible was born out of.

You can pray in tongues for a week, twenty-four hours a day, and He still seems inexhaustible. I have never come to the end of my prayer language. In His grace and mercy, God set up a system of teaching that goes beyond what you know.

Romans 8:27 says:

"And he that searcheth the hearts
knoweth what is the mind of the Spirit,
because he maketh intercession for the saints
according to the will of God."

The Holy Spirit searches your heart, and He already knows the mind of Christ. He knows God's plan for your personal life, His plan for your city, your calling, your ministry in the Body of Christ, and every specialized thing you are as an individual.

When you are baptized in the Holy Spirit, He represents you as an individual before the throne of grace. You cannot pray one hour in tongues without Him working to straighten your life and bring God's calling into it.

He searches your heart with the plan of God in mind, and He makes intercession for you according to the will of God. God is maneuvering you into your call so you will quit serving yourself.

The Holy Spirit is not only edifying you above lusts and sins of the flesh. There are three areas of sanctification: spirit, soul, and body. He wants to build you above fleshly bondages, and He also wants to deliver you from filthiness of soul: hatred, emulation, strife, unforgiveness, and similar things.

If you had told me before I was saved that I would someday be approaching agape and compassion, even lying in bed wondering whether I had hurt someone and caused them to go the wrong way, I would not have believed you. I would have said, "Goodbye. Do not let the door hit you." I could not imagine journeying into that foreign country of peace.

But He changed me. He wants me free from those things, and He also wants me delivered into the fullness of God's plan and will.

Even though 1 Corinthians 2 says the Holy Spirit compares spiritual with spiritual, Romans 8 gives more detail about how He does it. I do not know how to pray as I ought. The Holy Spirit steps in and begins to make intercession according to the will, purpose, pursuits, and plans of God. He that searches my heart knows the whole mind of Christ for me, so He can pray one hundred percent correctly for me hour after hour.

There is a deliberate way I can release my Teacher in me. I learned about meditation because I released my Teacher, and He taught me about meditation. People can have a Bible and the Holy Spirit and still stand up and expound on their ignorance. Some even read from the Bible to prove that the miracle-working power of the Holy Spirit passed away with the apostles.

Had I not received my Teacher, who prayed the mind of Christ for me, I would not have learned what I learned. I locked myself in the closet and prayed four, five, and six hours a day during my first year after being born again. The mind of Christ set my doctrine and my direction.

The Holy Spirit taught me how to assimilate the Word. Most of what I know came because He taught me how to release the mind of Christ.

But He can only guide you. He will not push, force, or drag. Contrary to popular teaching, He does not act like a criminal holding you hostage until you quote the verses back. If you are willing to be guided, He will guide you. To be guided, you must be willing to move.

Anyone can have this. I use "Mary Wallpaper" or "Joe Public" as examples of people outside the fivefold ministry. The sheep have access to as much revelation knowledge as we do. They may be trained in different fields, but they can know everything about God that the Holy Spirit is authorized to teach them.

Because the Holy Spirit releases the mind of Christ in every area of our lives, He makes intercession for us according to the will of God. In that will, God does not want me sick, bound, or unequipped. He wants me thoroughly furnished unto every good work.

Romans 8:28 says:

"And we know that all things work together for good
to them that love God,
to them who are the called according to his purpose."

When the will of God is being interceded for me by the power of the Holy Spirit, the mind of Christ will be manifested, and my life will fulfill that will. All the purpose, pursuits, and plans of God will begin to work together for good.

That does not mean everything in my life is already working together for good. It means the Holy Spirit has singled out everything not of God's purpose, pursuit, or plan, and through edification He intends to move it out.

I used to think "groanings which cannot be uttered" only meant speech that could not be fabricated with the mind. When I was a child, we played cowboys, Indians, and bandits, and we would make up syllables that sounded like another language. I thought Paul meant a language you cannot invent that way because it is born of the Spirit.

That is true, but there is more. I have never had trouble uttering my prayer language. Anytime I want to pray, my Teacher is there. Even when supernatural intercession came upon me for someone else, I did not have trouble groaning that either.

I remember praying in tongues all afternoon before a service. Suddenly I lapsed into a deadly silent world. I was so alone. There was nothing in that world, and I cried because of the loneliness. That night I stood before a woman born deaf, and suddenly I understood: I had entered her world in intercession.

I laid hands on both her ears. She went down under the power, and three-quarters of the way down the sound of the room filled her ears. She straightened like an ironing board, bounced back up, and stood in unbelief listening to the noise of the room. She began saying, "I can hear. I can hear." Her husband and children rushed to her, and there is no reward like that one.

Another pastor's wife, after praying in tongues for years, entered intercession and felt her arm and body begin to go numb as though paralysis were moving through her. She could have shocked herself out of it, but she let it run its course. That night a friend had a stroke. When they described the symptoms, she knew what to do. She went to the hospital, laid hands on her, and the feeling came back instantly.

That kind of intercession is real. But in Romans 8, Paul is also talking about the edification process that builds you up until you see a stronghold through God's eyes.

There may be an ugly thing embedded in your emotions, regularly making a play for your soul. At first, the Holy Spirit builds you up even with it. Then you begin to see it as God sees it. When you see it that way, you start hating it. When you hate it, you give God the faith He needs to move it out of your life.

When you loved it or did not care enough to do anything about it, what did He have to work with? But when you pray yourself into revelation and begin to hate that stronghold, the groaning comes. You cry, "God, I hate this. I hate that I have been involved with it."

He says, "Good. When you loved it, I had nothing to work with."

Many people never make it in a steady prayer life past that point. But the Holy Spirit helps our weaknesses with groanings that cannot be uttered when necessary, according to the will of God.

That is why Paul ends Romans 8 with bold statements. No creature, no thing present, no thing to come, no height, no depth can separate me from the love of God in Christ Jesus and His plan.

Sin cannot separate me when I am working His plan through the power of the Holy Spirit. Sickness and disease cannot separate me. The Holy Spirit is getting from me what God needs to separate me unto His overall purpose and pursuit.

If what I desired for Tulsa could have been done already, it would have been done. Therefore, something must be done that has not yet been done. My desire is to have an outpouring here that sweeps in the masses.

So be strong and rejoice in your path, for it is the path He has laid for you. He is able to do what He could not do before when He finds what He needs to do it with.

Be faithful, says the Lord.

Great days are coming.